GLOBAL ENTERPRISE SYSTEMS INC.

MASTER POLICY & COMPLIANCE HANDBOOK | DOC ID: GES-POL-2026-V4

SECTION 1. GOVERNANCE & ETHICAL STANDARDS

1.1 Policy Framework: Global Enterprise Systems Inc. ("GES") maintains strict adherence to legal, regulatory, and ethical standards across all operational jurisdictions. All employees, contractors, and affiliates are required to strictly observe the directives defined in this manual.

1.2 Conflict of Interest: Employees must ensure that no personal investments, secondary occupations, or external advisory roles conflict with their primary duties at GES. Immediate mandatory disclosure is required for any potential conflict involving family relations or personal financial holdings exceeding $10,000 in vendor or competitor stock.

1.3 Anti-Bribery & Foreign Corrupt Practices: GES strictly prohibits offering, promising, authorizing, or receiving bribes, kickbacks, or facilitation payments to public officials or private entity representatives. Any violation results in immediate termination and referral to regulatory authorities.

SECTION 2. EMPLOYMENT CLASSIFICATION & WORK SCHEDULES

2.1 Standard Working Hours: Standard core working hours are from 08:30 to 17:00 local site time, Monday through Friday. A total of 40 hours per week is required for full-time exempt and non-exempt personnel.

2.2 Remote & Hybrid Schedules: Employees eligible for Hybrid Schedule B may work remotely up to two (2) days per week upon completing a 90-day onboarding evaluation period and receiving manager sign-off.

Schedule Code	Eligible Tier	Max Remote Days/Wk	Core Attendance Requirement
SCH-A	Executive & Principal Staff	Unrestricted	Quarterly Onsite Summit
SCH-B	Senior Engineering / Ops	2 Days	Tue & Thu Onsite Core
SCH-C	Customer Service & Support	1 Day	Mon through Thu Onsite Core
SCH-D	Facilities & Hardware Lab	0 Days	100% Onsite Required

2.3 Time Tracking & Overtime: Non-exempt employees must accurately log all hours worked in the Kronos portal. Overtime exceeding 40 hours per week requires prior approval from department vice presidents.

SECTION 3. INFORMATION SECURITY & ACCEPTABLE USE (SEC-101)

3.1 Identity & Password Policy: Corporate Passwords must be at least 16 characters in length and include uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters. Password rotation occurs every 90 days. Systems enforce a history check preventing the reuse of the previous 12 passwords.

3.2 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Hardware security keys (e.g., YubiKey) or push notifications via the approved Duo Mobile app are mandatory. SMS-based 2FA is explicitly forbidden due to SIM-swapping risks.

3.3 Information Classification Matrix: Data owned or processed by GES is classified into four distinct levels:

- **Public (Level 1):** Marketing materials, press releases, public documentation.
- **Internal (Level 2):** Internal announcements, organizational charts, intranet articles.
- **Confidential (Level 3):** Customer PII, financial reports, proprietary codebases. Requires AES-256 encryption.
- **Restricted (Level 4):** Executive strategy, M&A keys, credential stores, customer encryption keys. Requires HSM storage.

SECTION 4. NETWORK & DEVICE SECURITY (SEC-102)

4.1 Workstation Encryption: Full-disk encryption (BitLocker or FileVault) is enforced via Central MDM. Disabling encryption or tampering with system security agents incurs immediate revocation of access privileges.

4.2 Remote Access VPN: All remote connections to internal infrastructure must pass through WireGuard or IPsec VPN with strict posture-checking enabled. Split tunneling is strictly disabled for non-approved endpoints.

4.3 Clean Desk & Screen Lock: Screen locks trigger automatically after 3 minutes of inactivity. Physical media or documents containing Level 3 or 4 data must be stored in lockable cabinets when unattended.

SECTION 5. LEAVE POLICIES & ABSENCE MANAGEMENT

5.1 Paid Time Off (PTO) Accrual: Full-time staff accrue PTO on a monthly basis according to tenure band:

Tenure Band	Monthly Accrual	Annual Total	Max Carryover Cap
0 to 2 Years	1.25 Days	15 Days	5 Days
3 to 5 Years	1.66 Days	20 Days	7.5 Days
6+ Years	2.08 Days	25 Days	10 Days

5.2 Sick & Emergency Leave: Employees receive 10 paid sick days annually granted on January 1st. Absences exceeding three (3) consecutive working days require a formal doctor's certificate uploaded to the HR service portal.

5.3 Parental Leave Policy: Birth mothers and primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave. Non-primary caregivers receive 8 weeks of fully paid leave. Eligibility requires 12 months of continuous full-time service.

SECTION 6. BEREAVEMENT, MILITARY & JURY LEAVE

6.1 Bereavement Leave: Up to five (5) paid days are provided for immediate family members (spouse, child, parent, sibling). Up to three (3) days are provided for extended family members.

6.2 Jury Duty: GES provides up to two (2) weeks of fully paid jury leave upon submission of formal court summons documentation to HR Payroll.

SECTION 7. TRAVEL & EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT (FIN-201)

7.1 Booking Protocols: All commercial travel must be booked through the Navan Corporate Portal at least 14 days in advance of departure unless urgent client resolution is documented.

7.2 Airfare & Lodging Allowance: Standard domestic flights must be Economy Class. Business Class is permitted only for international flights with direct flight durations exceeding 8 hours with VP approval.

Travel Tier	Hotel Cap / Night	Daily Per Diem (Meals)	Incidentals Cap
Tier 1 (NYC, London, Tokyo)	$320.00	$110.00	$25.00
Tier 2 (SFO, Berlin, Sydney)	$250.00	$90.00	$20.00
Tier 3 (All other cities)	$180.00	$70.00	$15.00

7.3 Expense Deadlines: All expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of expense incurrence via SAP Concur. Submissions exceeding 60 days are non-reimbursable.

SECTION 8. PROCUREMENT & CORPORATE CREDIT CARDS

8.1 Corporate Credit Card Usage: Corporate credit cards are issued to employees who incur regular business expenses (> $500/month). Cards are for business purchases only; personal charges are strictly prohibited and subject to immediate salary offset.

8.2 Purchase Order Thresholds: Purchases under $1,000 require Manager approval. Purchases between $1,001 and $10,000 require Director approval. Purchases exceeding $10,000 require VP and Finance approval.

SECTION 9. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & CONFIDENTIALITY (LEG-301)

9.1 Inventions & Work for Hire: All intellectual property, code, algorithms, patents, designs, and documentation created by employees during their tenure at GES belong exclusively to GES under international work-for-hire doctrines.

9.2 Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA): Employees are bound by non-disclosure restrictions during and after employment. Disclosing customer lists, proprietary algorithms, financial figures, or unreleased product roadmaps to third parties is strictly prohibited.

9.3 Open Source Software Contribution: Contributing code to external Open Source Software (OSS) projects on behalf of or using GES resources requires prior review by the Open Source Review Board (OSRB) to prevent IP leakage.

SECTION 10. SOCIAL MEDIA & PUBLIC COMMUNICATIONS

10.1 Public Spokespersons: Only designated Corporate Communications personnel are authorized to speak on behalf of GES to media outlets, journalists, or industry analysts.

10.2 Personal Social Media Guidelines: Employees must explicitly state on personal social profiles that opinions expressed are personal and do not represent GES. Disclosing internal company politics, upcoming earnings, or customer issues on social platforms is forbidden.

SECTION 11. WORKPLACE HEALTH, SAFETY & ENVIRONMENT (HSE-401)

11.1 Occupational Safety Standards: GES provides a safe and healthy working environment compliant with OSHA guidelines. All workplace accidents, injuries, or near-misses must be reported to Facilities within 4 hours of occurrence.

11.2 Emergency Evacuation Protocols: Fire drills take place semi-annually. Employees must familiarize themselves with primary and secondary evacuation routes posted near elevator lobbies and report to designated assembly areas during drills.

11.3 Ergonomic Assessment Program: Employees experiencing physical discomfort or strain during workstation operation can request an ergonomic evaluation and standing desk hardware through the HR Facilities portal.

SECTION 12. SUBSTANCE USE & SMOKING POLICIES

12.1 Drug-Free Workplace: The possession, sale, distribution, or consumption of illegal drugs or unauthorized controlled substances on corporate premises or during work hours is strictly prohibited.

12.2 Alcohol Consumption: Consumption of alcohol on company premises is strictly prohibited except during company-sanctioned events approved by HR or Executive management.

12.3 Tobacco & Vaping Restrictions: Smoking and e-cigarette usage are strictly forbidden inside all corporate facilities, parking garages, and within 25 feet of building entrances.

SECTION 13. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT & REVIEWS (HR-501)

13.1 Performance Evaluation Cadence: Formal performance reviews occur twice per calendar year: Mid-Year Review (July) and End-of-Year Review (January). Evaluations assess goals, core competencies, and values alignment.

13.2 Rating Calibration Scale: Performance ratings utilize a standardized 5-tier evaluation system:

Rating Level	Classification	Bonus Multiplier	Description
Level 5	Far Exceeds Expectations	125% - 150%	Consistently exceeds all KPIs and drives company-wide innovation.
Level 4	Exceeds Expectations	110% - 124%	Exceeds primary targets and demonstrates strong initiative.
Level 3	Meets Expectations	100%	Consistently fulfills all core job responsibilities and goals.
Level 2	Needs Improvement	0% - 50%	Fails to meet key deliverables; requires structured improvement plan.
Level 1	Unsatisfactory	0%	Consistently underperforms; subject to PIP or immediate release.

13.3 Performance Improvement Plans (PIP): Employees assigned a Level 2 or Level 1 rating enter a 60-day structured PIP with bi-weekly progress checkpoints with HR and management.

SECTION 14. PROMOTIONS & INTERNAL TRANSFERS

14.1 Eligibility Criteria: Employees must complete at least 12 months in their current role with a rating of "Meets Expectations" or higher before applying for internal transfers or promotion consideration.

SECTION 15. WHISTLEBLOWER & ANTI-RETALIATION (COMP-601)

15.1 Reporting Channels: Employees who observe unethical, illegal, or non-compliant conduct are encouraged to report incidents via the Ethics Hotline (Ext: 9911), email (ethics@ges.com), or the web-based reporting portal.

15.2 Anonymous Submissions: Reports submitted through the web portal or telephone hotline may be submitted completely anonymously. All reports are independently investigated by Legal Compliance.

15.3 Strict Anti-Retaliation Protection: GES enforces a strict anti-retaliation policy. Any attempt to demote, harass, threaten, or discriminate against an employee who submits a good-faith report is grounds for immediate discharge.

SECTION 16. DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS & TERMINATION

16.1 Progressive Discipline Framework: Violations of company policies are handled through a four-stage progressive discipline framework depending on severity:

1. Verbal Warning (documented in HR record for 6 months)
2. Written Reprimand (documented in HR record for 12 months)
3. Final Written Warning & Suspension Without Pay
4. Termination of Employment

16.2 Immediate Termination Offenses: Severe infractions including theft, violence, severe harassment, data sabotage, or gross negligence result in immediate summary dismissal without progressive warnings.

SECTION 17. DISASTER RECOVERY & BUSINESS CONTINUITY (BCP-701)

17.1 Incident Response Levels: Emergency response plans are categorized into three severity levels:

- **Level 1 (Minor):** Localized outage (single server/rack down). Handled by on-call site engineers within 1 hour SLA.
- **Level 2 (Major):** Regional data center outage or facility fire. Failover to secondary availability zone within 4 hours.
- **Level 3 (Critical):** Global infrastructure disruption or severe cyber event. Executive Incident Commander assumes authority.

17.2 Data Backup & Recovery SLAs: Core databases enforce a Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of 15 minutes and a Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of 2 hours. Backups are tested monthly.

SECTION 18. DATA PRIVACY & COMPLIANCE (GDPR / CCPA)

18.1 Personal Data Handling: All processing of customer or employee personal data must strictly comply with GDPR, CCPA, and relevant global privacy legislation.

18.2 Subject Access Requests (DSAR): Data subject access or erasure requests must be logged into the Privacy Portal immediately. Requests must be fulfilled within 30 days by the Data Protection Officer (DPO).

SECTION 19. HARDWARE ASSET & LIFECYCLE MANAGEMENT

19.1 Asset Tagging: All physical hardware exceeding $250 in value must be tagged with a QR asset barcode by IT Ops prior to assignment.

19.2 Laptop Lifecycle Refresh: Laptops are refreshed on a fixed 36-month schedule. Old devices are securely wiped according to NIST SP 800-88 standards before recycling or employee purchase options.

Hardware Class	Standard Specification	Refresh Interval	End of Life Action
Engineering Workstation	64GB RAM / 2TB NVMe / i9 or M3 Max	36 Months	NIST Wipe / E-Waste Recycle
Standard Office Laptop	16GB RAM / 512GB SSD / i7 or M3 Base	48 Months	NIST Wipe / Employee Buyout Option
Mobile Test Handsets	Flagship iOS / Android Devices	24 Months	Internal Lab Pool

SECTION 20. POLICY ACKNOWLEDGMENT & REVISION HISTORY

20.1 Annual Re-certification: All employees must re-certify their compliance with this Master Policy Manual annually via the Compliance Learning Portal every January.

20.2 Policy Revisions: GES reserves the right to amend or update policies at any time. Changes are communicated via corporate email with 30 days' advance notice before taking effect.

> **End of Document:** Total indexed sections: 20 | Version 2026.1 | Approved by Executive Operations Committee.